Personas

Persona 01 – The Everyday Planner

Short description:

A busy parent who cooks dinner most days, uses recipes often and wants anything that cuts down the daily “what’s for dinner?” effort.

Profile

Name: Marte

Age: 39

Occupation/ situation: Works shifts in a care job, lives with a family who don’t always agree on food

Cooking frequency: Almost every day

Cooking confidence: Medium to high. She likes cooking and enjoys trying food from other cuisines.

Typical device: Phone

Goals

1. Get a weeknight dinner on the table in about 30 minutes.
2. Plan meals ahead so she doesn’t have to come up with ideas every day.
3. Find dishes the whole household will eat, with room to try new cuisines.

Frustrations

1. Blog-style pages where she has to scroll a long way to reach the recipe.
2. Ads that get in the way of the content.
3. Unfamiliar measurement units and ingredients that are hard to find locally.

Recipe search behavior

How they find recipes: Googles the dish name, uses recipe websites, gets ideas from meal kits (like HelloFresh), TikTok and Instagram.

What do they look for: A specific dish, a cuisine or region (like Asian food), quick meals, and meat, fish or vegetarian options.

What makes them choose a recipe: Good reviews, an appealing photo, ingredients she already has or can easily buy.

Most important information

Rank or highlight the information that matters the most to this persona:

- ☒ Ingredients
- ☒ Preparation time
- ☐ Cooking time
- ☐ Difficulty
- ☒ Number of servings
- ☒ Dietary information
- ☐ Calories/nutrition
- ☒ Reviews/ratings
- ☒ Photos
- ☐ Other:

Needs

1. Ingredients and time shown right at the top, with a “jump to recipe” option
2. Adjustable servings and switchable units
3. Tools to plan meals and shop

Feature expectations

This persona would likely benefit from:

- Meal planner, favorites and an automatic shopping list
- Filters for time, cuisine and meat/fish/vegetarian, plus ingredient substitutes
- Step-by-step photo instructions

Quote

“Anything that saves me from having to figure out what to make is great. On a weekday it has to be done in half an hour.”

Research basis

Based on: Participant #2 and #4.

Key insight from interviews:

Both cook almost every day and use recipes several times a week, mostly on their phone. For them a recipe is part of a daily routine. They want the ingredients right away, the option to adjust servings, and anything that helps with planning (favourites, meal plans, shopping lists). Their frustrations are about stuff that slows them down: long blog intros, ads, units they don't use and ingredients that are hard to find.

Persona 02 – The Occasional Cook

Short description:

A practical person who cooks now and then, mostly simple dishes, and uses a recipe mainly when making something new. He needs clear, precise instructions to feel confident.

Profile

Name: Jonas

Age: 25-55

Occupation/ situation: Full-time office job

Cooking frequency: One to a few times a week. Uses a recipe roughly once a week, mostly for new dishes.

Cooking confidence: Low to medium. He's comfortable with familiar dishes but unsure with new ones.

Typical device: Finds recipes on his phone and follows them on a tablet or PC while cooking

Goals

1. Make a new dish successfully.
2. Find simple recipes with few steps and everyday ingredients.
3. Find what he needs quickly without hunting it down on a cluttered site.

Frustrations

1. Unclear or confusing steps, especially when several things are cooked at the same time.
2. Vague measurements (e.g. "1 carrot" instead of grams) and recipes that assume he has made the dish before.
3. Cluttered homepages with a hard-to-find search bar, and recipes with too many ingredients.

Recipe search behavior

How they find recipes: Googles the dish name (like"chocolate cake recipe") or a general search like "quick and easy dinner" or sometimes goes to sites he already knows.

What do they look for: Quick, simple everyday dishes, sometimes gluten-free or a specific main ingredient like meat or chicken.

What makes them choose a recipe: A good, a clear description, and how easy it seems to make.

Most important information

Rank or highlight the information that matters the most to this persona:

- ☒ Ingredients
- ☒ Preparation time
- ☐ Cooking time
- ☒ Difficulty
- ☒ Number of servings
- ☒ Dietary information
- ☐ Calories/nutrition
- ☒ Reviews/ratings
- ☒ Photos
- ☐ Other:

Needs

1. Clear step-by-step instructions that explain when tasks run in parallel.
2. Precise measurements in weight or volume, with ingredients from a normal grocery store.
3. A clean site with a visible search bar and simple categories.

Feature expectations

This persona would likely benefit from:

- A cooking toggle mode that keeps the screen on if wanted.
- Upfront difficulty view, number of steps, ingredient count and tools needed.
- Simple categories (weekday dinner, weekend, cakes, desserts), an easy to find search bar and a favourites tab.

Quote

“If the picture looks good and the steps are clear, I'll try it. If there are too many ingredients, I will just find another website to try.”

Research basis

Based on: Participant #1 and #3.

Key insight from interviews:

Key insight from interviews:

Both cook simple meals and mainly use recipes for dishes they haven't made before. Photos are the leading factor for what recipe they decides to make. Their biggest pain points are about clarity: unclear steps, bad measurements, too many ingredients and cluttered websites. They often decide whether a recipe is doable before they start so the site needs to show that on the homepage. All of this showed in both a younger and an older participant, so age is not a defining factor for this persona.